

Aviation hub-bub, now, bridge the gulf

India has **embarked on** a much **overdue** expansion of international air carriage capacity, and is justified in not expanding **bilateral** agreements with countries in West Asia. Aviation **hubs** in the region **rely on** international travel from India. They have benefited from the lack of long-range wide-bodied aircraft operated by Indian airlines. This situation is changing, with Air India and IndiGo placing orders for around 1,000 jetliners with Boeing and Airbus. But deliveries will be **spread out**, and adequate capacity on international routes will take time to build. It is to be expected that West Asian carriers will **seek** expanded **bilateral** agreements and that Indian airlines will oppose the demand. Allowing more **inventory** would work in favour of Gulf carriers that enjoy a significant fuel price advantage.

The Gulf carriers argue, as some voices have in the ongoing IATA AGM in Delhi, that it may not be in the interest of Indian travellers if their capacities are **stranded** while Indian airlines build their **fleets**. They have a point in that supply **constraints** could affect market growth. The fare **dynamics**, however, do not **call for** government intervention. Indian airlines have **soaked up** most of the aircraft available on **lease** while they wait for deliveries. They need to match Gulf carriers on price, volume and service quality. **Gaining** market share on the West Asia route **is vital** to India's **ambition** of having its own aviation hub. It's **pitting** the rising number of Indian passengers - expected to **drive** international air travel growth in the coming **decade** - against West Asia's, which serves as an obvious **transit point** among Asia, Europe and Africa.



Capacity addition across India's aviation value chain has been **remarkably rapid** in recent years. While most of it is **directed** at increasing domestic air travel, market dynamics also require a strong international presence as well. The country is correcting its **chronic** overdependence on foreign airlines to **ferry** Indian passengers and needn't **heed** the **resultant heartburn**. **[Practice Exercise]**

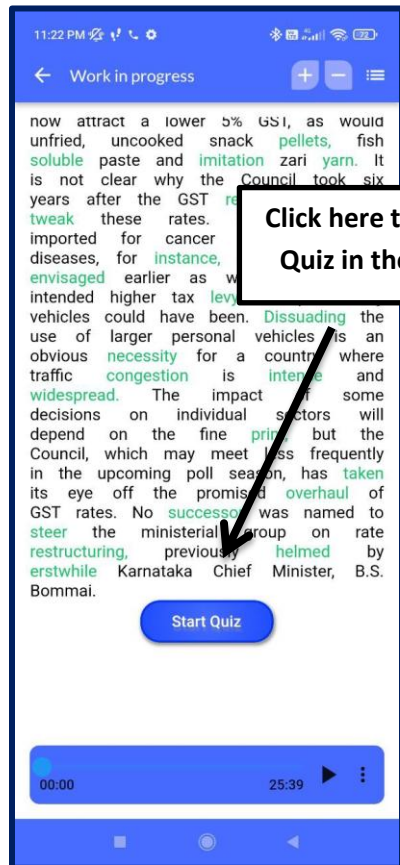
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

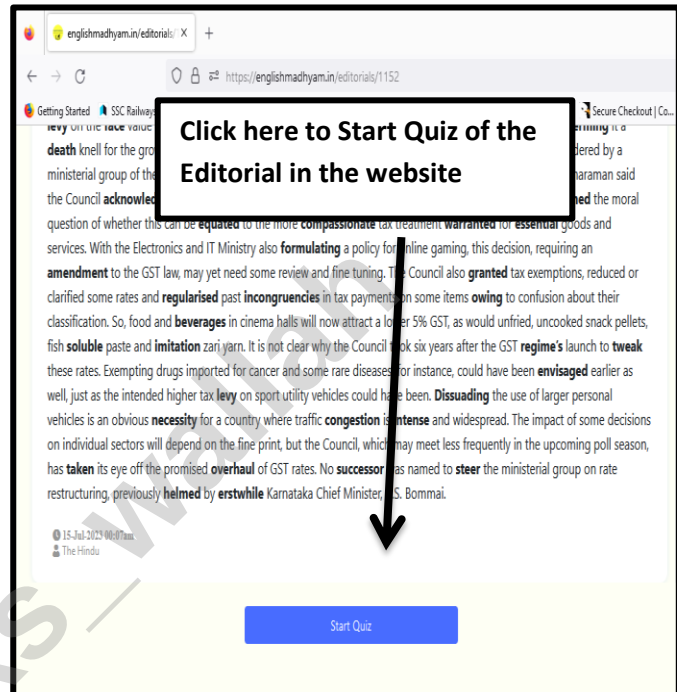
1. **Hub-bub** (noun) – uproar, commotion, chaos, turmoil, ruckus शोरगुल / हलचल
2. **Bridge the gulf** (phrase) – close the gap, reconcile, connect, unite, overcome division दूरी कम करना
3. **Embark** (on) (verb) – begin, start, initiate, undertake, launch शुरू करना
4. **Overdue** (adjective) – late, delayed, pending, belated, behind schedule बहुत देर से लंबित
5. **Bilateral** (adjective) – mutual, two-sided, reciprocal, joint, shared द्विपक्षीय
6. **Rely** (on) (verb) – depend, trust, count on, bank on, lean on निर्भर होना
7. **Spread out** (phrasal verb) – extend, distribute, space out, scatter, stretch फैलाना / विस्तारित करना
8. **Seek** (verb) – request, pursue, ask for, aim for, look for तलाशना
9. **Inventory** (noun) – stock, supply, collection, list, catalog सूची / भंडार
10. **Stranded** (adjective) – stuck, trapped, marooned, isolated, helpless फंसा हुआ
11. **Fleet** (noun) – group of vehicles, aircraft, navy, convoy, collection बेड़ा
12. **Constraint** (noun) – limitation, restriction, barrier, hindrance, curb बाधा
13. **Dynamics** (noun) – forces, factors, mechanisms, trends, workings प्रवृत्तियाँ / गतिशीलता
14. **Call for** (phrasal verb) – require, demand, need, appeal for, request माँग करना
15. **Soak up** (phrasal verb) – absorb, take in, consume, draw in, utilize उपयोग करना
16. **Lease** (noun) – rental agreement, contract, hire, tenure, occupancy किराया अनुबंध
17. **Vital** (adjective) – essential, crucial, key, important, necessary अत्यावश्यक
18. **Ambition** (noun) – goal, aspiration, aim, dream, objective महत्त्वाकांक्षा
19. **Pit** (verb) – oppose, confront, match, compete, challenge आमना-सामना कराना
20. **Drive** (verb) – propel, push, motivate, stimulate, lead प्रेरित करना
21. **Decade** (noun) – Period of ten years दशक
22. **Transit point** (noun) – a place, like a city or country, through which goods or people pass while traveling from one destination to another. पारगमन बिंदु

23. **Remarkably** (adverb) – notably, strikingly, extraordinarily, exceptionally, significantly उल्लेखनीय रूप से
24. **Rapid** (adjective) – fast, quick, swift, speedy, accelerated तीव्र
25. **Direct** (at) (verb) – aim, focus, target, point, address लक्षित करना
26. **Chronic** (adjective) – persistent, long-term, constant, prolonged, habitual दीर्घकालिक
27. **Ferry** (verb) – transport, shuttle, carry, convey, move पहुँचाना / लाना-ले जाना
28. **Heed** (verb) – pay attention, listen to, consider, take notice, obey ध्यान देना
29. **Resultant** (adjective) – resulting, consequent, ensuing, following, emerging परिणामी
30. **Heartburn** (noun) – resentment, irritation, annoyance, bitterness, frustration खिन्नता / जलन

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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